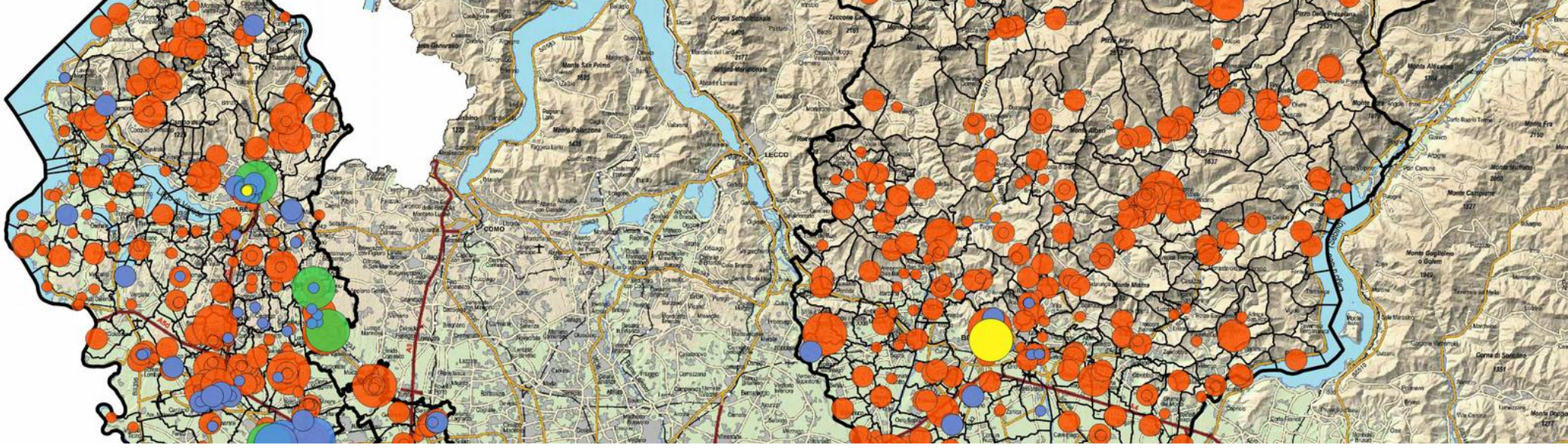


Which urban habitats are selected by Swifts? A citizen science program to answer the question in provinces of Varese and Bergamo, Italy

Milo Manica[1,2], Silvana Nembrini[1], Daniela Casola[2], Alessandra Stocchetti[2], Lorenzo Colombo[1,2], Alison Parnell[2], Manuela Bazzarelli, Grazia Zulian[3], Claudia Iadanza[4], Rebecca Milani[4], Roberto Ambrosini[4], Costante Cavallaro[1], Walter Guenzani[2], Stefania Villa[1]

1 LIPU Birdlife Italia, via Udine 3/A – 43122 Parma, 2 Gruppo Insubrico di Ornitologia, via Manzoni 21 – 21050 Clivio (VA), 3 Joint Research Centre, Via Enrico Fermi, 2749 – 21027 Ispra (VA), 4 University of Milan, Facoltà di Scienze e Tecnologie, via Festa del Perdono 7 – 20122 Milano

INTRODUCTION

The importance of knowing the conservation status of the Swifts in our territory prompted us to design the project

Sulle ali dei rondoni (On the wings of Swifts)

This started with the collaboration of two associations

Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

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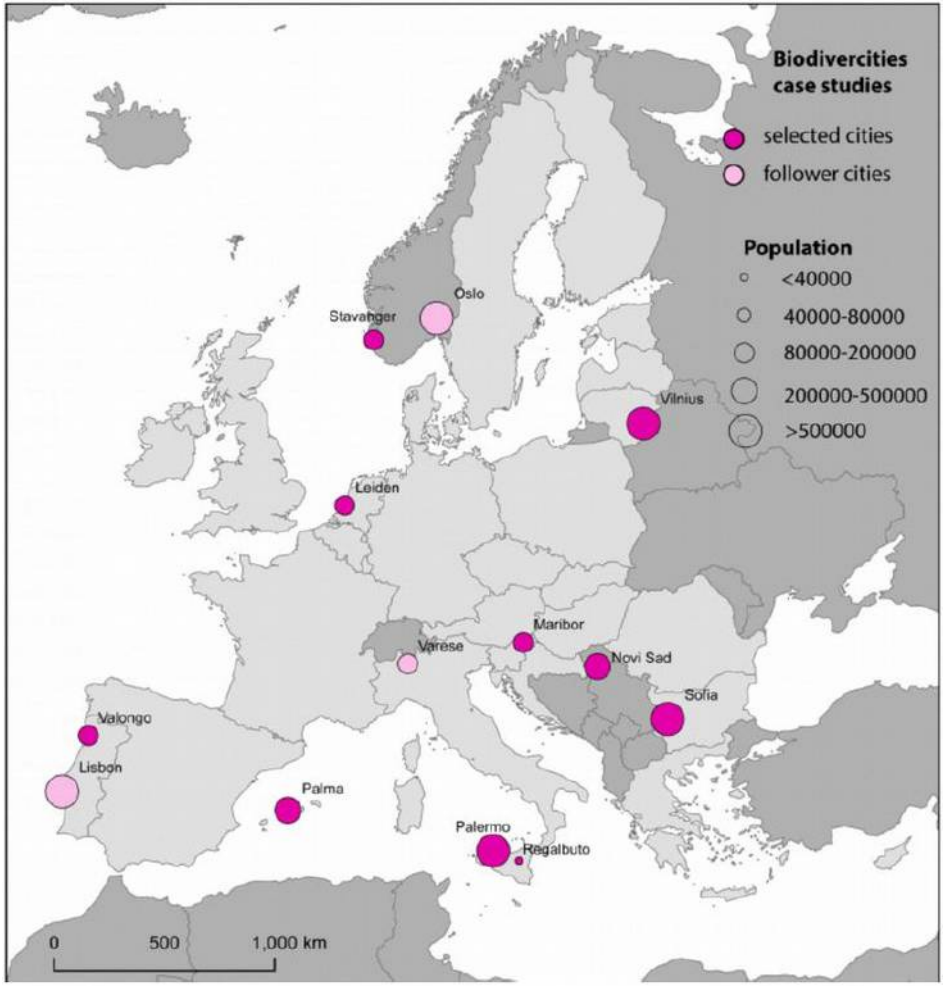
Then support arrived from two municipalities and European Commission

Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

INTRODUCTION

Our project was selected for the **BiodiverCities** program:

We are involved in the European program together with other important cities



Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

OBJECTIVES

- Map of the colonies
- To improve scientific knowledge
- Supporting conservation initiatives
- Raising people's awareness



Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

METHODS

- Sulle ali dei rondoni is a **citizen science** project which aims to involve citizens, schools and institutions in monitoring the colonies of Swifts in the provinces of Varese and Bergamo
- 90 **volunteers** were involved
- We organized **two webinars** in order to train volunteers



Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

METHODS

VN | Econews

NATURA

Sulle ali dei rondoni: 350 nidi siti di nidificazione individuati da ottanta partecipanti al censimento

Azioni concrete di tutela nel comuni di Varese e Jerago con Orago

Joint Research Centre (JRC) · lipu · rondoni · jerago con orago · varese





SempioneNews
L'asse del Sempione a portata di click.

Ambiente, Territorio | 3 Luglio 2021

"Sulle ali dei rondoni": 350 nidi da proteggere in provincia di Varese

Grazie al progetto "Sulle ali dei rondoni", individuati 350 nidi e siti di nidificazione dagli ottanta partecipanti al censimento. Partono subito le azioni concrete di tutela nel comuni di Varese e Jerago con Orago

Sulle ali dei rondoni

Varese – **Ottanta partecipanti e 350 osservazioni** di siti di nidificazione in **provincia di Varese**: prosegue il progetto **Sulle ali dei rondoni**, l'attività di citizen science ideata per **censire e mappare le colonie di rondoni** sul territorio varesino.



VARESE IL PROGETTO AMBIENTALISTA

Maggiore, Comune o Pallido Il primo censimento dei rondoni

Squadre di volontari per mappare specie e nidi. Coinvolte 25 amministrazioni

Andrea Camurani

Varese sentinella della biodiversità

Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

METHODS







Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

METHODS



VA sulle ali dei rondoni

Rilevatore	Data	Ora inizio	Ora fine

Punto GPS o Indirizzo

Specie	Stima numerica
○ Rondone Comune	○ < 10
○ Rondone Maggiore	○ 11 - 30
○ Rondone Pallido	○ 31 - 50
	○ > 50

Tipo di edificio	Sito di nidificazione	Esposizione
○ Palazzo	○ Tegole/Sottotetto	○ Nord
○ Torre	○ Infissi finestra	○ Sud
○ Religioso (Chiesa/Campanile)	○ Buca pontaia/Fessura	○ Est
○ Rondonaia (Torretta/Parete)		○ Ovest

Note:

Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

METHODS

- Creation of a **WhatsApp group** to coordinate volunteers
- **Census of colonies** from May to September with data sheets:
  - Species
  - Number of individuals
  - Type of buildings
  - Kind of nest site
  - GPS coordinates
  - Orientation of the nest site
- Some short **excursions in small groups** to place of interest in the area
- **Data analysis**:
  - Urban habitat preferences?
  - How to improve conservation of Swifts?



Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

FIRST RESULTS



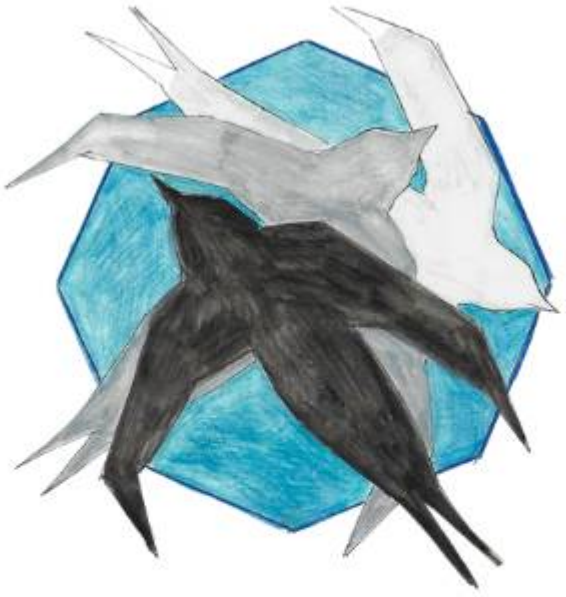
SULLE ALI DEI RONDONI

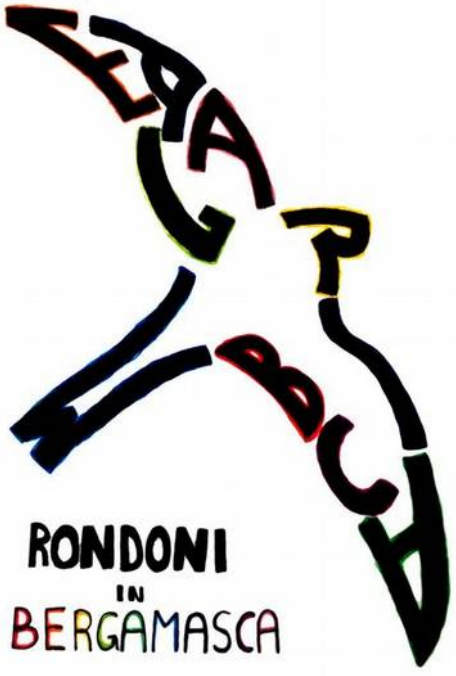
Censimento dei rondoni in provincia di Varese

Progetto a cura di

Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

FIRST RESULTS





Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

FIRST RESULTS



Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

FIRST RESULTS



Si attesta che la classe:

.....

ha partecipato al concorso per la realizzazione del logo del Progetto

Sulle Ali dei Rondoni

curato da

Gruppo Insubrico di Ornitologia e LIPU - Sezione di Varese

in collaborazione con il **progetto europeo BiodiverCities** ottenendo una

MENZIONE SPECIALE

per la qualità della proposta in termini di ideazione e realizzazione del logo

Il presidente
del Gruppo Insubrico di Ornitologia
Gualtiero Guenzani

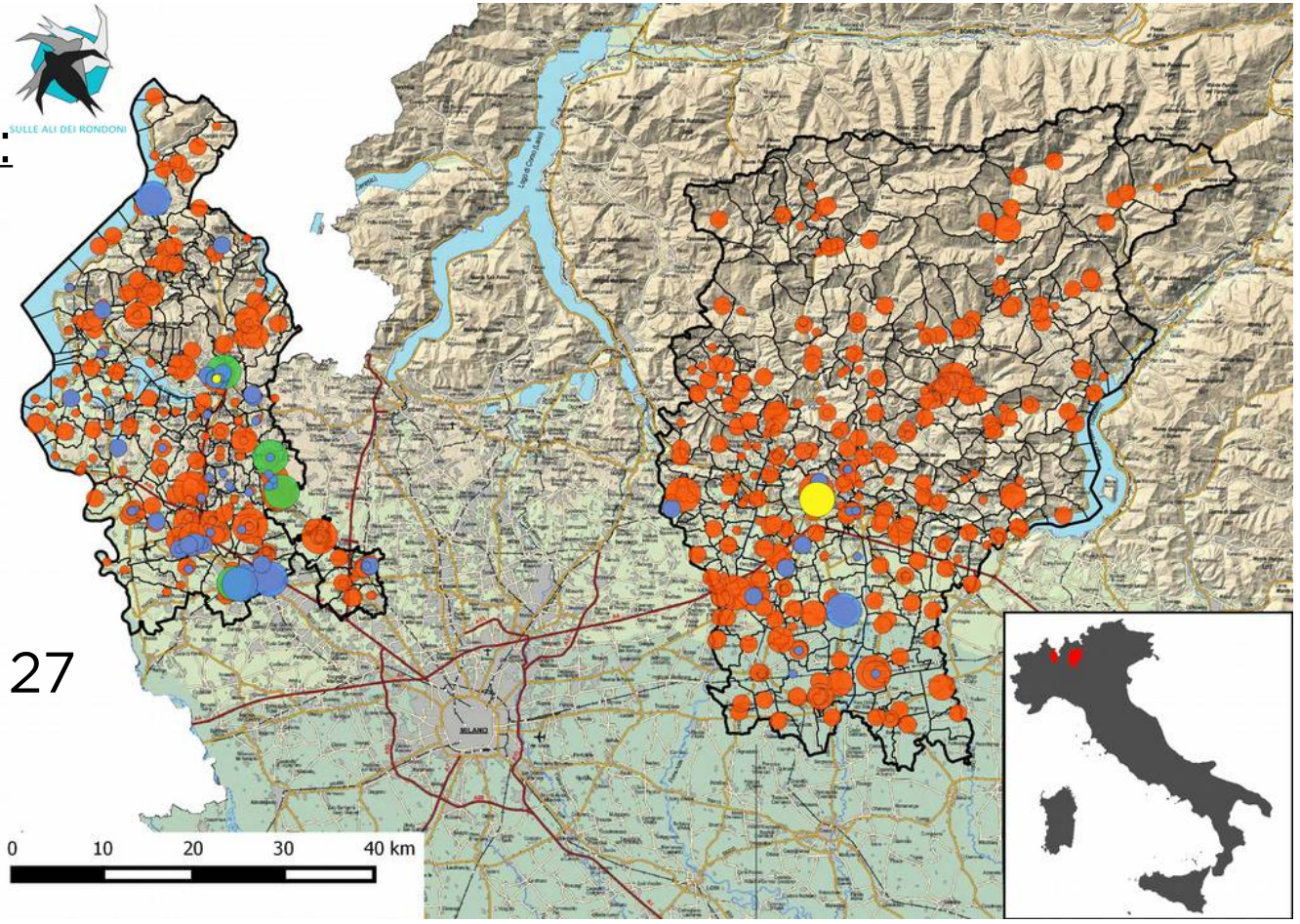
La delegata
della LIPU - Sezione di Varese
Stefania Villa

Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

FIRST RESULTS

In the first year (2021):

- **74%** of territory covered
- **818** Swifts colonies found
- Discovery of **Pallid Swift** in Varese after 27 years
- **Collaboration** with municipalities

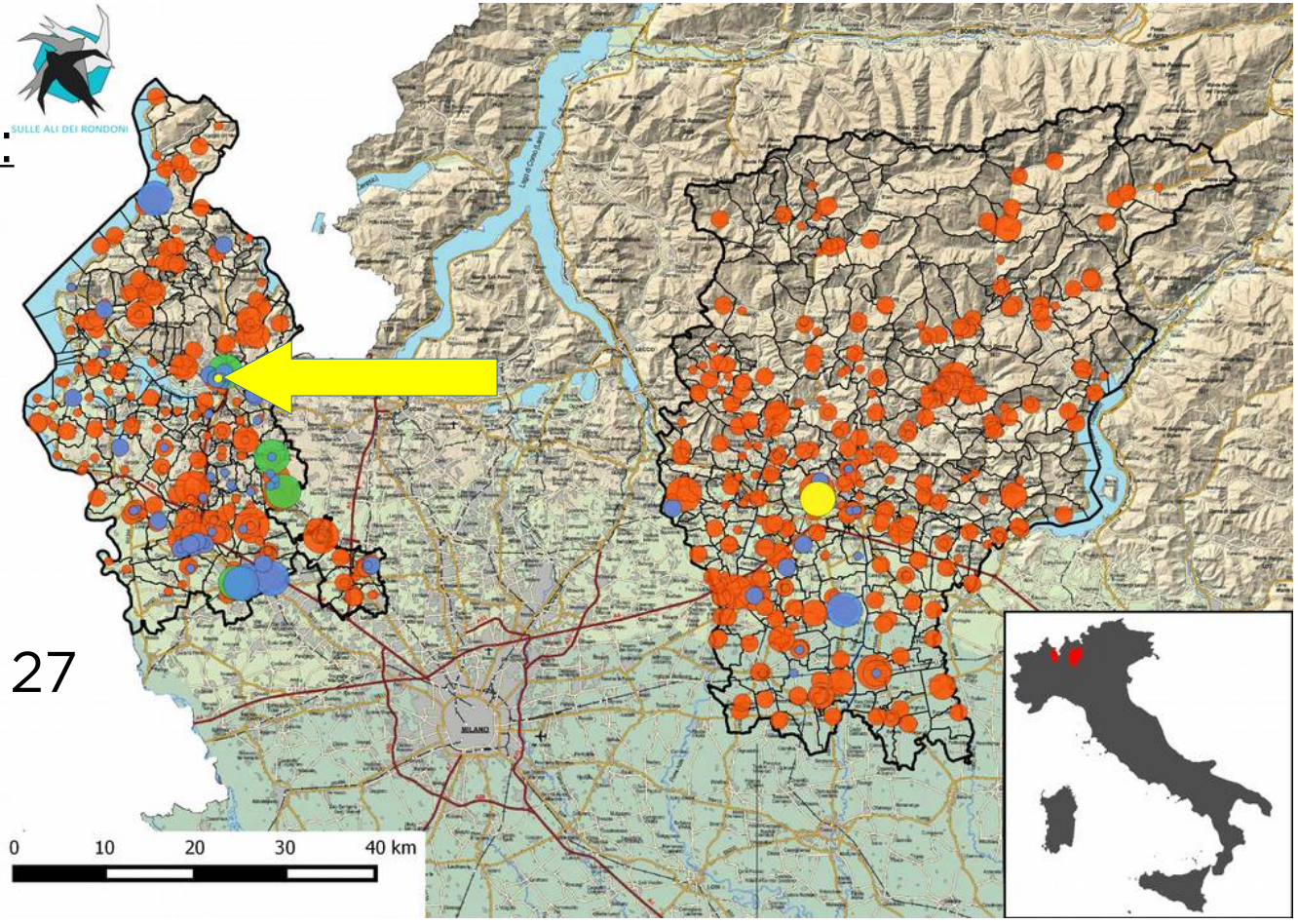


Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

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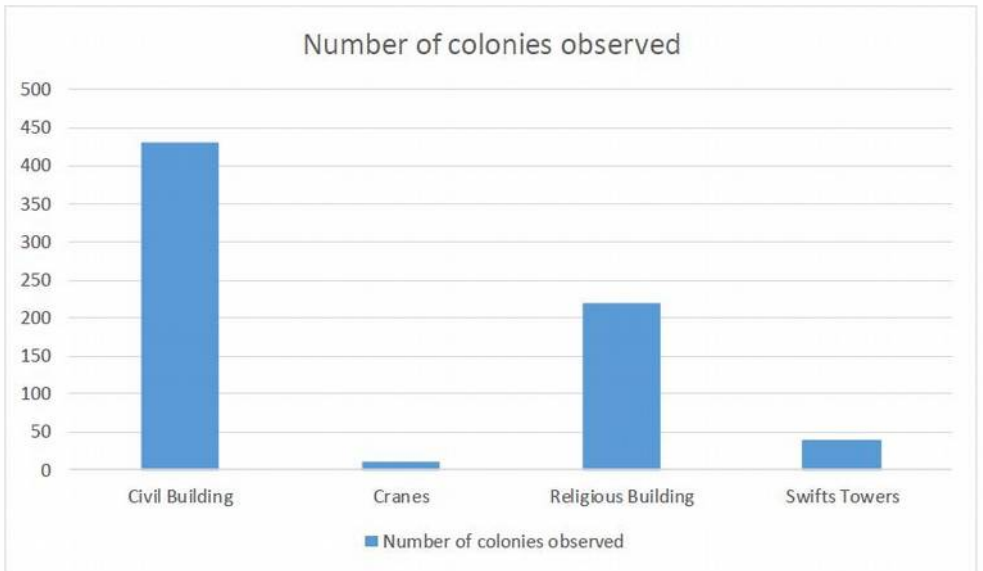


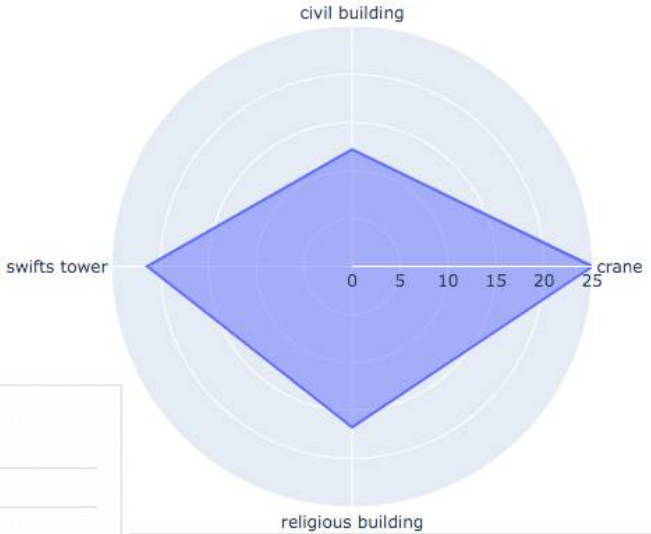
SULLE ALI DEI RONDONI Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

FIRST RESULTS

Common Swift:

- Larger colonies in cranes and Swift walls/towers







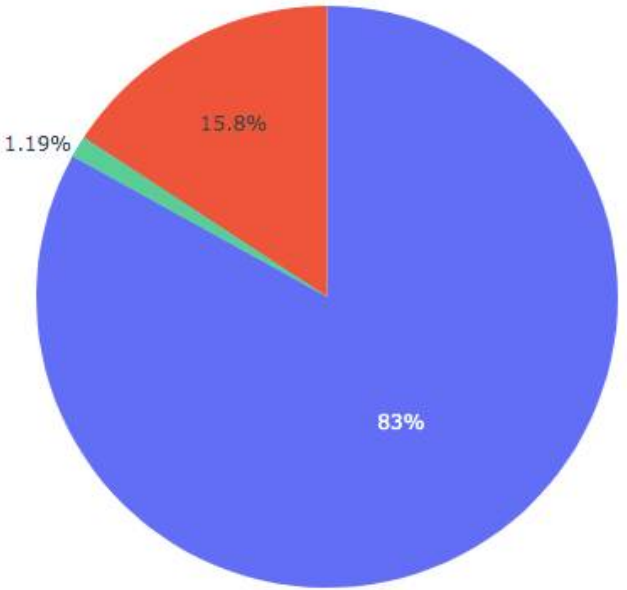


Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

FIRST RESULTS

Common Swift:

- Larger colonies in cranes and Swift walls/towers
- Tiles and roofs the preferred choice



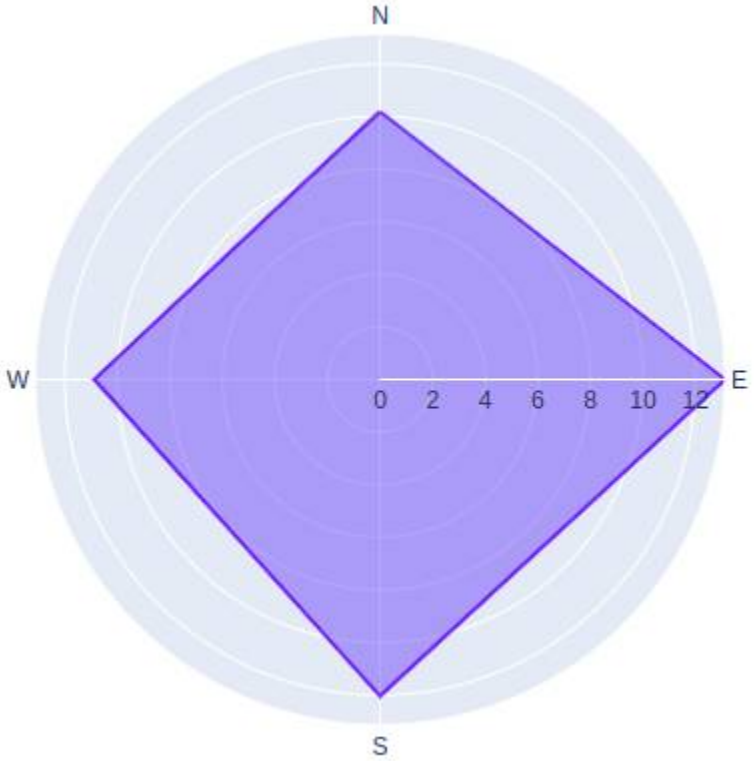


Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

FIRST RESULTS

Common Swift:

- Larger colonies in cranes and Swift walls/towers
- Tiles and roofs the preferred choice
- No preference for the orientation of the nest site

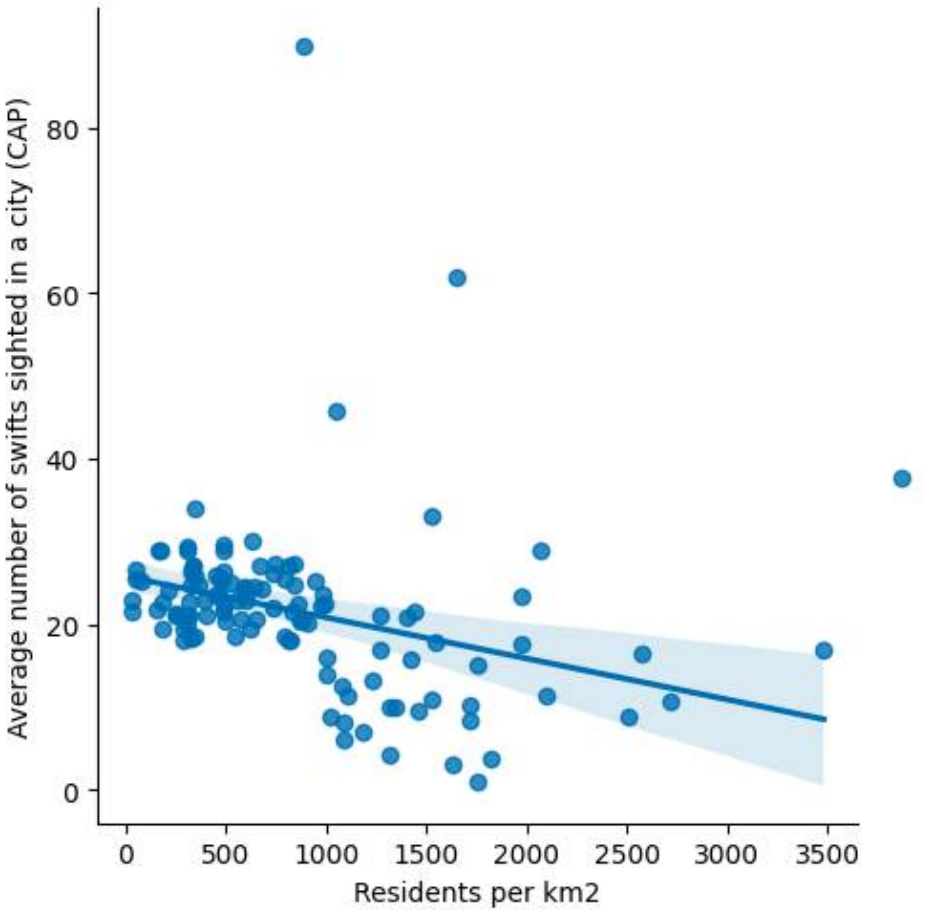


Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

FIRST RESULTS

Common Swift:

- Larger colonies in cranes and Swift walls/towers
- Tiles and roofs the preferred choice
- No preference for the orientation of the nest site
- Less densely populated cities preferred



Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

FIRST RESULTS

Alpine Swift:

?



Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

DISCUSSION

- We covered 74% of the territory in the first year of the project and found 818 colonies in two Italian provinces
- Importance of Swift towers (according to Ferri, 2018)
- Roof tiles are the most used site (according to Boano, 2012 and Pirovano et al., 2022)
- No orientation preferences (according to Galeotti, 1993 and Bronne, 2009)
- Interesting preference for the less densely populated cities
- Continuation of data analysis for the other species and geospatial analysis

Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

ACTIONS







Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

ACTIONS

We stopped building work at nest sites with the collaboration of municipalities during the breeding season



Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

ACTIONS

We increased available nest sites in two cities:

- Gallarate → Alpine Swifts





Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

ACTIONS

- We increased available nest sites in two cities:
- Gallarate → Alpine Swifts
- Varese → Pallid Swifts



Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

NEXT STEPS

- Second year fill in the gaps in the map
- Activate conservation initiatives and environmental protection policies with municipalities involved



Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

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- LIPU – BirdLife Italy and GIO
- All the volunteers
- Schools
- University students
- Municipalities
- European Commission

Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com

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Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com



THANKS FOR YOUR ATTENTION

SULLE ALI DEI RONDONI Milo Manica milomanica@gmail.com